

The bottom line is: life happens. We all hope bad things won't happen to us, but sometimes they do. And I want you to be financially prepared for the worst, even while you hope it never happens.

Money Mistake: *You Think Long-Term Care Insurance Is a Waste of Money*

The Fix: *Get a Quote Today*

Remember those tribal families where parents had to have 12 kids because so few stayed alive? Today is a very different story. A Canadian man born between 1920 and 1922 was expected to live to be 59, a woman to 61. Nearly a hundred years later, those numbers have gone up by 20 years. A baby boy born between 2007 and 2009 in Canada is expected to live to be 79; a baby girl will live a rich, long life of 83 years. By 2020, there will be as many seniors as children. And by 2036, an expected 25 percent of the population will be over 65.

Unfortunately, living a longer life doesn't necessarily mean living a healthier one. As life expectancies climb, the number of seniors who require some form of long-term care continues to rise as well. *Seventy percent of people turning 65 today can expect to use some form of long-term care during their lives.* Put another way, if your parents are in their 60s, their chances of needing long-term care are seven in 10.

"So what?" you say. "We're Canadian—our health care is covered." Not so fast. Long-term facilities-based care is not publicly insured under the Canada Health Act; it's up to each province to determine precisely which costs are covered and which are not. As a result, costs and services vary widely, and there is little consistency in the level and type of care offered. The government is already struggling under the increasing costs of geriatric medical care. Canada currently spends \$3.9 billion a year on Alzheimer's and dementia, and there is no end in sight. By 2031, nearly one million Canadians will be afflicted with dementia.